Mkoba Vendor Guide

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1. Welcome to Mkoba

Mkoba keeps your business accounts on **WhatsApp**. You write what you sold, bought and spent in your own words. Mkoba saves it, shows your profit, your debts and your stock, and helps you get a loan.

Mkoba number (WhatsApp): +255 788 001 168

How to start

1. Save that number in your phone as "Mkoba".
2. Open WhatsApp and send Mkoba any message, for example `hello`.
3. Read how your data is used, then reply `I AGREE`.
4. Send your name.
5. Send your type of business (for example `food`, `shop`, `vegetables`). To skip this question, send `skip`.
6. You are ready. At any time, send `help` to see all the commands.

Remember:

- Mkoba saves nothing until you reply `I AGREE`.
- A reply that starts with `Done!` means it was saved.
- To make sure Mkoba always replies in English, send `english`. Swahili commands still work.

2. Recording sales, purchases and expenses

There are three kinds of record:

Kind	Example to send
Sale (money in)	`sold chips 5000`
Purchase (goods to sell or to cook with)	`bought rice kilo 10 for 25000`

Kind	Example to send
Expense (rent, electricity, fare, wages)	`paid electricity 15000`

Mkoba replies, for example: `Done! Added sale of chips TSh 5,000. Thanks!`

Writing the amount

All of these are TSh 5,000: `5000`, `5,000`, `5k`. Write amounts as numbers. English number words (such as "five thousand") are not understood; the Swahili `elfu tano` is.

Quantities and units

You can add kilos, litres or pieces: `kilo 10`, `litre 5`, `pcs 3`. These help Mkoba count your stock (section 6).

Several records at once

Put each record on its own line:

```
sold chips 5000
bought oil 8000
```

Items by count only

If you send `sold soda 10` (a small number without TSh), Mkoba understands 10 sodas, not TSh 10. It uses your last soda price and asks you to confirm. If it has no price, it asks how much, for example: `sold 10 soda for 3000`.

By voice

You can also send a **voice note** (under 1 minute). Mkoba shows what it heard, for example `🎤 I heard: "sold chips 5000"`, then asks `YES` or `NO` before saving.

Remember: a record gets the date and time Mkoba received it. Record on the same day as the business.

3. Confirming, deleting and correcting

When Mkoba asks YES or NO

If Mkoba is not sure, it shows what it understood and asks `Is this right? Reply YES or NO.`

- Reply `YES` to save.
- Reply `NO` to discard, then send it again correctly.

The question waits **1 hour**. If you send a new record before answering, the old one is dropped.

Deleting the last record

Send `undo`. Mkoba deletes the records from your last message, for example `Deleted sale of chips TSh 5,000.` Send `undo` again to delete the one before.

Changing the amount of the last record

Send `correct` and the right amount, for example `correct 6500`. Mkoba replies `Corrected sale of chips: TSh 6,000 → TSh 6,500.`

To change the kind or the item: send `undo`, then send the record again.

When Mkoba says "I didn't understand"

If you get `Sorry, I didn't understand...`, nothing was saved. Make sure the message has an action word (sold / bought / paid) and an amount, then send it again.

4. Summaries and the evening report

Seeing your numbers

Send	You get
`today`	Today's numbers
`yesterday`	Yesterday's numbers
`week`	This week (since Monday)

Send	You get
`month`	This month
`balance`	Since you started

Profit = Sales − Purchases − Expenses. If it is below zero, you see **Loss**. Debts are not counted in profit.

Evening report

Every day at **9 pm**, Mkoba sends you a summary of the day if you recorded anything that day. On Sunday you get the whole week's summary and a list of who owes you.

- To stop: `STOP REPORTS`
- To turn back on: `START REPORTS`

5. Debts

What happened	Send
A customer took goods on credit (they owe you)	`Juma owes me 5000`
You took goods on credit (you owe them)	`I owe Juma 5000`
They paid you	`Juma paid 2000`
You paid them	`nimemlipa Juma 2000` (Swahili, see below)

Every reply shows the new balance, for example `Balance: Juma owes you TSh 3,000.`

Important:

- There is no English command yet for paying back a debt you owe. Use the Swahili `nimemlipa Juma 2000`. `I paid Juma 2000` is saved as an **expense**, not a debt payment.
- Use one word for the name (`Juma`), or a title and name (`Mama Neema`, `Mr Ali`). Use the same name every time.

Seeing debts

- Everyone: `debts`. You see who owes you and whom you owe, with the days since each debt started.
- One person: `debt Juma`

Reminding a customer

1. Send `debt Juma`.
2. You get a second, ready-made message: `Hello Juma, a reminder of your balance ...`
3. Press and hold that message, choose **Forward**, and send it to Juma.

6. Stock

Mkoba counts the goods you have from your records: **purchases with a quantity add**, **sales with a quantity subtract**. Example: `bought rice kilo 10 for 25000` adds 10 kg of rice.

To do	Send
Set the amount you have now	`stock rice kilo 20` (several items: `stock oil litre 5, sugar kilo 2`)
See all stock	`stock`
Be told when it reaches a level	`stock rice below 5`
Go back to the automatic alert	`stock rice below auto`

- If you don't set your own level, Mkoba warns you when the stock left will last about **2 days** of your sales.
- The warning comes once: `⚠️ rice is running low: 5 kg left.`
- A `?` in the list means Mkoba doesn't know the amount yet; set it with `stock rice kilo 20`.
- Records without a quantity (`sold chips 5000`) don't change stock.

7. Customer receipts and points

Giving a receipt

1. Send `receipt`, the customer's number, then what they bought: `receipt 0712345678 chips 5000`
2. Mkoba saves the sale and sends you the receipt.
3. Press and hold the receipt, choose **Forward**, and send it to the customer.

Points

- A customer earns **1 point for every TSh 1,000** on a receipt.
- One customer's points: `points 0712345678`
- Your best customers: `points`
- When a customer uses points (you decide the reward): `redeem 0712345678 20`

8. Your shop: items and orders

List your items and prices, and customers can order from you on WhatsApp or online.

Setting up items

To do	Send
Add an item or change a price	`catalog add chips 3000, soda 600`
See the list, your shop number and links	`catalog`
Sold out / available again	`catalog out chips` / `catalog in chips`
Remove an item	`catalog remove chips`

`catalog` shows **your shop number** (for example `shop 4108`) and the links to give customers.

How does a customer order?

- **WhatsApp:** they send `shop 4108` (or `duka 4108`) to Mkoba, pick items by number (for example `1x2, 3`), send `send`, then their name and place. They can send `pickup` to collect it themselves, or share their location.

- **Online:** they open `mkoba.digital/k/4108`, choose items, and enter their name and number.

Handling orders

To do	Send
See waiting orders	`orders`
See one order	`order 1`
Accept	`accept order 1`
Reject	`reject order 1`
Paid and handed over	`complete order 1`

`complete order` records the sale, reduces stock, and gives the customer points and a receipt. If an order arrives when you haven't messaged Mkoba for 24 hours, you'll see it when you send your next message.

9. Bulk buying (Jirani)

You join a group of nearby vendors with a collection point. You order together every week at wholesale prices.

Group

To do	Send
See groups	`groups`
Join	`join SIN01` or `join Sinza`
Find the nearest group	Share your location (📎 > Location)
Create a group	`create group Sinza Mori, Sinza`
Your group	`my group`
Leave	`leave group`

The weekly bulk order

1. Add what you need: `bulk rice kilo 20` (or several items: `bulk rice kilo 10, oil litre 5`).
2. See the group order: `bulk`. Remove an item: `bulk remove rice`.
3. The order closes **every Friday evening**. You get your share, the price, the total and where to collect.
4. When the goods arrive and you have collected them: `bulk received`. Mkoba records your purchase and adds to your stock.

To receive the goods somewhere else: `deliver home <address>`, `deliver to <place>`, or `collect group` (back to the collection point).

10. Score, business statement and lenders

Your Mkoba score

Send `score`. You get a score from 0 to 100 based on your last 90 days of records, its parts, and advice to raise it. A score needs at least **14 days with records** within **30 days**.

Best ways to raise it: record **every day**, record all costs, reduce debts, paste your mobile money SMS, and use receipts.

Business statement for a lender

1. Send `statement`.
2. You get a link to a 6-month statement (sales, costs, profit, debts and score). It works for 30 days.
3. Send that link to the lender or SACCO.
4. To close it early: `CLOSE STATEMENT`.

Lenders connected to Mkoba

To do	Send
See lenders and who has permission	`lenders`
Allow a lender	`allow NMB`
Decline their request	`decline NMB`

To do	Send
Remove permission	`revoke NMB`

A lender sees only your business statement and score, not your individual records or messages. You can remove permission at any time.

11. Mobile payments and boda delivery

Paying by phone

If you get a message with `💳 Pay ... by phone` (for example for a bulk order), pay in one of these ways:

- Send `PAY`, then enter your PIN on the prompt that comes to your phone.
- Or open the link sent and pay on the Selcom page.

When the payment is confirmed, you get `✅ Payment of ... received`. When your customers pay an order by phone, you are told `💳 Order #... was paid by phone`. Money for your orders is collected by Mkoba and then paid to you.

Boda delivery

- When you accept a delivery order, Mkoba finds a boda rider and tells the customer the delivery fee.
- The fee is worked out by distance. For this, **share your shop's location** once (📎 > Location).
- When a rider takes the job, you get their name and number; when the goods arrive, you are told `✅ Order #... was delivered.`

12. Dashboard, Mkoba app and USSD

Dashboard (online)

1. Send `dashboard`.
2. Open the link within 15 minutes and tap **Ingia** (Log in). The dashboard pages are in Swahili.

3. You see profit, a 14-day chart, recent records, debts, stock and score. You stay logged in for 30 days on that phone.

Mkoba app (works without internet)

1. On the dashboard, tap 📱 **Fungua programu ya Mkoba** (Open the Mkoba app), or open `mkoba.digital/d/app`. The app uses your Mkoba language.
2. To put it on your phone's home screen: tap **Add Mkoba to your home screen**, or in the browser menu choose **Add to Home screen**.
3. It has five tabs: **Home**, **Records**, **Stock**, **Orders**, **Debts**.

Without internet you can still add records. They wait on the phone and are sent automatically when the connection returns.

USSD (any phone, no internet)

Dial Mkoba's USSD code (Mkoba will give it to you). You get a menu: record a sale, purchase or expense; today's and this week's summary; debts; stock; and delete the last record. It is the same account as WhatsApp.

13. Language, privacy and deleting your data

- **Language:** for English replies send `english`; for Swahili send `kiswahili`.
- **Privacy:** your data is yours. Mkoba does not sell it or give it to anyone, except the services that make Mkoba work (WhatsApp and our server). Read more: `mkoba.digital/privacy`.
- **Deleting all your data:**
  1. Send `DELETE MY DATA`.
  2. Within 10 minutes, send `DELETE EVERYTHING` to confirm.
  3. Everything is deleted and **cannot be brought back**. Backup copies delete themselves within 14 days.

Difference: `undo` deletes only the last record. `DELETE MY DATA` deletes everything.

14. Common problems

Problem	Do this
Mkoba doesn't reply	Check your internet and that you are writing to +255 788 001 168. Wait a little, send again.
Every reply asks me to agree	Send `I AGREE`.
`Sorry, I didn't understand`	Send an action word and an amount, for example `sold chips 5000`.
A small number wasn't saved as money	A number under 100 without TSh is a count. Send the total: `sold 5 mandazi for 3000`.
Saved as the wrong kind	Send `undo`, then send again with the right word.
My debt payment was saved as an expense	Send `undo`, then send `nimemlipa Juma 2000`.
I replied YES but it wasn't saved	The 1 hour passed, or you sent another record first. Send again.
One person appears twice in debts	You wrote the name two ways. Use one name every time.
The dashboard link doesn't work	15 minutes passed or it was already used. Send `dashboard` again.
Delivery says "fee to agree with the rider"	Share your shop's location once.
`Sorry, something went wrong on our side`	Wait a few minutes, send again.

Help: send `help` to see all the commands. For something Mkoba can't do (changing your name, fixing an old record), contact the Mkoba team. Give your WhatsApp number, what you sent, what Mkoba replied, and the date. The Mkoba team will never ask for your password or PIN.

15. Quick card

To do	Send
Sale / purchase / expense	`sold chips 5000` / `bought rice kilo 10 for 25000` / `paid electricity 15000`
Confirm / reject	`YES` / `NO`
Delete last / change amount	`undo` / `correct 6500`
Numbers	`today`, `yesterday`, `week`, `month`, `balance`
Evening report	`STOP REPORTS` / `START REPORTS`
Debts	`Juma owes me 5000`, `I owe Juma 5000`, `Juma paid 2000`, `nimemlipa Juma 2000`
See debts	`debts` / `debt Juma`
Stock	`stock` / `stock rice kilo 20` / `stock rice below 5`
Receipts and points	`receipt 0712345678 chips 5000` / `points` / `redeem 0712345678 20`
Shop items	`catalog` / `catalog add chips 3000` / `catalog out chips`
Orders	`orders` / `accept order 1` / `reject order 1` / `complete order 1`
Bulk buying	`groups` / `join SIN01` / `bulk rice kilo 20` / `bulk received`
Score and loans	`score` / `statement` / `CLOSE STATEMENT`
Lenders	`lenders` / `allow NMB` / `revoke NMB`
Pay by phone	`PAY`
Dashboard and app	`dashboard`
Language	`english` / `kiswahili`
Help	`help`
Delete all data	`DELETE MY DATA`, then `DELETE EVERYTHING`